

Half-pin in combinations

By C.G.S.Narayanan

Of all the ideas that lend themselves to thematic combination, the half-pin is the most fruitful. In a half-pin set up two black pieces are positioned in between the Black king and a white line piece. When either of the black men moves off the line during the course of the play, the other gets fully pinned, and this immobility is then exploited by white to deliver a pin mate. Half pin problems generally involve pinning of each of the two black pieces in turn to produce harmonious effect of the pin mates. The half-pin lines can be either lateral or diagonal and the pieces pinned can be homogeneous i.e similar pieces like two knights or heterogeneous with different kinds of pieces. Such problems are often complex without without being crowded.

A.Bottachi
L'italia Schachitsica 1919



Mate in two moves

Key 1.Ne6! (2.Qe4)

1...Rxe6 2.Qb5; 1...dxe6 2.Qd4

1...Rc5 Qxd7; 1...Nc5 2.N(e)c7

1....Nd6 2.N(5)c7

This meredith has four variaions involvng half-pin and self-block with an excellent triple-sacrifice key albeit with a give and take key.

However there is a mate provided for the flight 1...Kc5 2.Qb5.

A.Mari

1st prize, Good Companion 1921



Mate in two moves

In the splendid problem above the Italian maestro achieved four thematic variations with interferences, two by each half-pinned piece and with some fair by play. The variation 1...Bd4 2.Nd6 is called switchback. **Key 1.Nxc4!** (threat 2.Qxe5) 1...Bd6 2.Nd2; 1...Ng4 2.Nxf4; 1..Nd5 2.Qd6.

In the problem for solving given below each of the half-pinned black pieces is induced to free WQ by interference unpin.

Comins Mansfield
2 Pr, 8th American Congress 1921



Mate in two moves

Solution to problem for solving in the article 'BCPS Centenary Review'

Key 1.Qc2! waiting (1...bN any 2.Rd6; 1...bNd4 2.Bc4; 1...eN any 2.Rc5; 1...eNd4 2.Re5; 1...B any 2.Qc5 1....Bd4 2.Qc4; 1....Re4 2.Qxe4 1...Rd4 2.Qf5

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